TOP COVER

REMOVAL

WARNING: ON VEHICLES EQUIPPED WITH AIRBAGS, DISABLE THE AIRBAG SYSTEM BEFORE ATTEMPTING ANY STEERING WHEEL, STEERING COLUMN, OR INSTRUMENT PANEL COMPONENT DIAGNOSIS OR SERVICE. DISCONNECT AND ISOLATE THE BATTERY NEGATIVE (GROUND) CABLE, THEN WAIT TWO MINUTES FOR THE AIRBAG SYSTEM CAPACITOR TO DISCHARGE BEFORE PERFORMING FURTHER DIAGNOSIS OR SERVICE. THIS IS THE ONLY SURE WAY TO DISABLE THE AIRBAG SYSTEM. FAILURE TO TAKE THE PROPER PRECAUTIONS COULD RESULT IN ACCIDENTAL AIRBAG DEPLOYMENT AND POSSIBLE PERSONAL INJURY.

(1) Disconnect and isolate the battery negative cable.

(2) Using a trim stick or another suitable wide flat-bladed tool, gently pry the instrument panel top cover up and away from the instrument panel far enough to disengage the five snap clip retainers from their receptacles in the instrument panel structural support (Fig. 16).

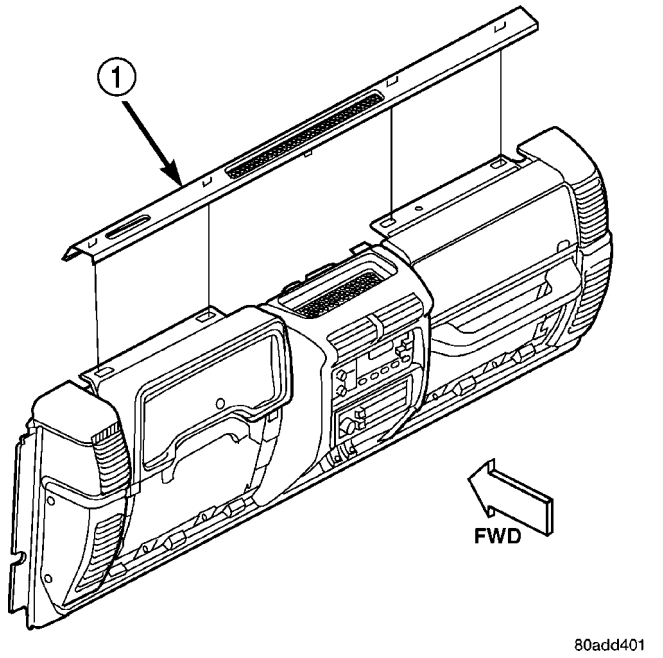

Fig. 16 TOP COVER REMOVE/INSTALL

1 - TOP COVER

(3) Remove the top cover from the instrument panel.

INSTALLATION

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(1) Position the top cover onto the instrument panel (Fig. 16).

(2) Align the snap clips on the top cover with the snap clip receptacles in the instrument panel structural support.

(3) Using hand pressure, press firmly downward on the top cover over each of the snap clip locations until each of the snap clips is fully seated in its receptacle in the instrument panel structural support.

(4) Reconnect the battery negative cable.